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YOUNG ACHIEVERS OF KASHMIR



Suvan Sharma
(AIR 148)

Sugandha Gupta
(AIR 207)

Towseef Ahmad Ganaie
(AIR 254)

Ritika Bhan
(AIR 456)

The Next Generation Is Getting Ready for More

The Legends Ink

Ink that speaks the truth.

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INK THAT SPEAKS THE TRUTH.

Monthly Magazine

For a Better, Informed Society



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Cell: 9469549483 | Email: thelegendsink@gmail.com

THE Legends ink

Owner, Publisher & Editor:
Parvaiz Ahmad Reshi

Executive Editor:
Fayaz Qureshi

Managing Editor:
Nahida Noor

Associate Editor:
Milind Champanerkar
Aijaz Ahmad

Chief Advisor:
Dr. Suresh Khairnar

Bureau Chief
Reshi Junaid

Legal Adviser
Adv. Zeza Majid Qureshi
Adv. Khalid Qureshi

Graphic / Layout Designer
Ubaid Malik
Contact: +91 7006618090

Correspondence:
Parvaiz Ahmed Reshi

Printed At:
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R.N.I No: JKENG/26/A6059
Email: thelegendsink@gmail.com
Phone: +91 97970 45196

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Editorial

Drugs in Kashmir: The Battle Is Far From Over

The fight against drugs in Jammu & Kashmir has entered a more intensive phase. Police and other enforcement agencies have increased arrests, seizures, investigations and action against properties allegedly linked to drug trafficking. Yet the continuing appearance of trafficking networks shows that enforcement alone cannot end the problem.

Recent NCB investigations have identified heroin routes reaching Jammu & Kashmir through Punjab as well as the Uri sector, demonstrating the cross-border and inter-state dimensions of the trafficking problem.

The Indian Express +1

The challenge is therefore not only to arrest the person selling drugs on the street. Authorities also have to identify the suppliers, financiers, transport networks and organisers behind the trade. At the same time, young people already affected by addiction need treatment, rehabilitation and opportunities to rebuild their lives.

J&K currently has one Integrated Rehabilitation Centre, six District De-addiction Centres and 21 Addiction Treatment Facilities, according to the Government of India.

Press Information Bureau

The real measure of success will ultimately be a Kashmir where fewer young people enter addiction in the first place—not simply a higher number of arrests. Police enforcement, community participation, schools, families, healthcare providers and rehabilitation services all have a role.

Possible cover/editorial headline:

"Drug-Free Kashmir: The Police Battle Is Only One Part of the Fight"



Omar Abdullah as Chief Minister: Between Expectations and Delivery

A government facing extraordinary political limitations—and extraordinary public expectations

When Omar Abdullah returned as Chief Minister of Jammu and Kashmir in October 2024, his government inherited a political landscape unlike that faced by any previous elected government in the region. Jammu and Kashmir was no longer a state; it remained a Union Territory, with the elected government operating within a constitutional and administrative arrangement in which the Lieutenant Governor retains significant powers.

The expectations of the people, however, were much larger than the powers available to the government.

For many voters, the return of an elected government represented a return of political voice, accountability and hope. People expected employment, better roads, improved electricity supply, stronger healthcare and education, relief for struggling families, tourism growth and, above all, restoration of statehood.

Nearly two years into the Omar Abdullah government's tenure, the central question is therefore not simply whether the government has succeeded or failed. The more important question is: What has



it actually delivered, what remains unfinished, and how much of the responsibility lies with the elected government itself?

That is the test on which the administration should ultimately be judged.

Statehood: The biggest political test

For the National Conference and Omar Abdullah personally, restoration of statehood has remained one of the most important political commitments.

The government has repeatedly demanded that Jammu and Kashmir's statehood be restored. In July 2026, Omar Abdullah led a political campaign in Delhi demanding restoration of statehood. Yet the campaign faced criticism for failing to generate sufficient political momentum, while questions also emerged over whether the government's conciliatory approach towards the Centre had produced the desired result.

This presents a difficult political dilemma.

The Chief Minister cannot restore statehood himself. The decision ultimately lies with the Union government and Parliament. But voters naturally judge the elected government by the results it obtains.

The people therefore have a legitimate question:

If statehood was one of the principal political promises, what concrete strategy will finally deliver it?

Dialogue with New Delhi is necessary. Confrontation for the sake of confrontation is unlikely to help. But dialogue must also produce results.

The government needs a clearly defined roadmap, regular public reporting and a stronger political consensus involving all regions and major political forces of Jammu and Kashmir.

Statehood cannot remain merely an election slogan. It must become a measurable political objective.

Employment: The biggest concern of the younger generation

Perhaps no issue affects ordinary families more directly than unemployment.

For years, thousands of educated young people in Kashmir and Jammu have prepared for government examinations, often spending years waiting for recruitment. The pressure on young people is enormous because government employment remains highly sought after in an economy where suitable private-sector opportunities are still limited.

The Omar Abdullah government has made recruitment and employment a major part of its policy agenda.

According to the government's 2026-27 Budget presentation, 7,650 candidates were appointed to government service during 2025, while the government proposed fast-tracking recruitment for another 23,800 posts, including gazetted, non-gazetted and Class-IV positions.

These figures are important.

But numbers alone cannot solve the employment crisis.

Jammu and Kashmir needs an economy capable of producing employment beyond government departments.

Tourism, horticulture, handicrafts, information technology, food processing, small industries, logistics, renewable energy and entrepreneurship must become genuine employment engines.

The government has also proposed that industrial units receiving government concessions should give priority to local youth in employment. That is a potentially important policy direction because investment should not simply mean land being provided to companies; it should mean jobs, skills and income for local communities.

The real test, however, will be implementation.

A young person does not measure economic growth through a budget document. He or she measures it through one simple question:

"Where is my job?"

The economy: Growth on paper and prosperity on the ground

The government's 2026-27 Budget projected Jammu and Kashmir's Gross State Domestic Product at approximately ₹3.16 lakh crore, with estimated growth of 9.5 per cent over the revised estimate for 2025-26. PRS also notes a targeted revenue surplus of about ₹9,378 crore and a fis-



cal deficit target of 4.6 per cent of GSDP.

These are encouraging indicators.

But economic statistics should never become a substitute for people's lived experience.

A family struggling with school fees, electricity bills, healthcare expenses and rising household costs does not necessarily feel the benefit of a higher GSDP.

The government's economic challenge is therefore twofold: increase the size of the economy and ensure that growth reaches ordinary households.

This is particularly important in rural Kashmir, where many families depend on agriculture, horticulture, small businesses, daily wage work and traditional occupations.

Economic development must be inclusive.

Relief for the poorest

One positive feature of the 2026-27 Budget is its focus on economically vulnerable households.

The government proposed six free LPG cylinders annually for families covered under the Antyodaya Anna Yojana, along with education-related support for vulnerable children and incentives for government employees serving in remote areas.

The Budget also proposed full fee waivers in government schools for eligible AAY students in Classes IX to XII and government degree colleges, subject to the scheme's conditions.

Such measures can make a real difference.

But welfare schemes must be accompanied by effective delivery.

The poorest citizens are often the least capable of navigating complicated government procedures. A scheme that exists on paper but requires multiple visits to offices is not truly accessible.

The administration should therefore strengthen doorstep delivery, digital access, grievance redressal and social audits.

Electricity: A sensitive test of governance

Electricity remains one of the most sensitive economic issues for ordinary households.

For a middle-class family, a higher electricity bill may be an inconvenience. For a poor household, it can mean choosing between electricity, food, medicine and school expenses.

The government therefore faces a difficult balance between the financial health of the power sector and affordability for consumers.

Jammu and Kashmir's electricity system has historically suffered from high losses, infrastructure problems and a gap between the cost of supplying power and the revenue collected.

Reform is necessary.

But reform cannot simply mean transferring the financial burden to consumers.

The government should aggressively pursue reduction of transmission and distribution losses, modernisation of infrastructure, transparent billing and targeted support for vulnerable households.

The principle should be simple:

Efficiency for the system, affordability for the poor.

Healthcare: More than buildings and announcements

Healthcare is another area where expectations are high.

Jammu and Kashmir has made significant progress in medical infrastructure over the years, but infrastructure alone does not guarantee quality healthcare.

The government must focus on doctors, nurses, paramedics, medicines, diagnostic facilities and emergency services.

Recent protests by medical interns over long shifts and a reported monthly stipend of 12,000 have also raised questions about working conditions for medical trainees.

The administration should treat such disputes not merely as administrative problems but as opportunities to improve the healthcare system.

A strong public-health system depends on motivated healthcare workers.

The government should also strengthen primary healthcare in rural and remote areas so that people do not have to travel long distances to Srinagar or Jammu for basic treatment.

Education: The foundation of tomorrow

Education remains Jammu and Kashmir's greatest long-term investment.

The government deserves credit whenever it expands opportunities for poor students. But education policy must go beyond construction of classrooms.

Government schools need quality teachers, modern laboratories, digital facilities, libraries, career counselling and vocational education.

At the same time, the burden placed on poor parents by private schools deserves serious attention.

Parents frequently complain about fees, uniforms, books, transport and other expenses.

The government should strengthen regulation where necessary while simultaneously improving government schools so that parents have a genuine alternative.

Education should not become a race in which the income of parents determines the future of their children.

Development and infrastructure

Roads, bridges, drainage, water supply and public transport remain fundamental measures of governance.

Jammu and Kashmir's geography makes infrastructure development expensive and difficult. Landslides, floods, snowfall and difficult terrain regularly disrupt connectivity.

Yet citizens reasonably expect projects to be completed within a defined timeframe.

Long delays damage public confidence.

The administration should introduce stronger project monitoring, publicly available completion timelines and accountability for contractors and departments responsible for delays.

A bridge that remains incomplete for years is not merely an engineering problem—it is a governance problem.

Similarly, roads repeatedly dug up without proper restoration impose an unnecessary cost on citizens.

Development should be measured not by the number of projects announced but by the number of projects completed.

Srinagar and the challenge of urban governance

Srinagar's growing population has created enormous pressure on roads, drainage, waste management, parking and public spaces.

Traffic congestion has become a daily experience for residents.

The government's decision to initiate an external audit of the Srinagar Smart City project is therefore significant. Such an exercise can help determine whether major public investments achieved the objectives for which they were approved.

But audits should not stop at reports.

If irregularities or poor implementation are found, responsibility must be fixed.

Citizens have the right to know where public money has gone and what value they have received from it.

Environment: Development cannot destroy Kashmir

Kashmir's greatest economic and cultural asset is also its most fragile: its natural environment.

Dal Lake, Wular Lake, rivers, wetlands, forests and mountains cannot be treated simply as scenery for tourism.

Recent reporting has highlighted severe pressures on Kashmir's water bodies from pollution, untreated sewage, encroachment, invasive weeds and climate change.

The Omar Abdullah government therefore faces an environmental responsibility that extends beyond its own five-year term.

Development must be sustainable.

Tourism without environmental protection will ultimately destroy the very product on which tourism depends.

A clean Dal Lake is not only an environmental objective. It is an economic necessity.

Tourism and the new opportunity

Tourism remains one of Jammu and Kashmir's biggest economic opportunities.

The government has increasingly promoted tourism, culture and film-related activity. In September 2026, Omar Abdullah inaugurated the first International Film Festival of Jammu & Kashmir in Srinagar and spoke about restoring Kashmir's historic relationship with the Indian film industry.

Such initiatives can help diversify the tourism economy.

But tourism development must reach beyond famous destinations.

Villages, lesser-known historical sites, trekking routes, local cuisine, handicrafts and homestays can generate income across communities.

The objective should be community-based tourism, where local people become beneficiaries rather than spectators.

Governance and the question of accountability

Good governance is ultimately about accountability.

Citizens should be able to ask government departments:

Where is the project?

How much money was sanctioned?

Who received the contract?

When should the work be completed?

Why has it been delayed?

Who is responsible?

The administration has spoken about transparent recruitment, digital governance and administrative reform. Its 2026-27 Budget states that Mission Karmayogi training had covered a significant number of government employees and that recruitment was being pursued through technology-driven processes.

These reforms are welcome.

But transparency must extend beyond recruitment.

It must cover procurement, contracts, land, public works, transfers and government expenditure.

The fight against corruption cannot be selective.

The political challenge

Omar Abdullah's government also operates under intense political pressure.

The BJP has accused the NC-led government of failures, while the Chief Minister has in turn accused political opponents of attempts to destabilise his government.

Political competition is normal in a democracy.

But Jammu and Kashmir cannot afford a government that spends more time responding to political accusations than solving public problems.

Nor can opposition parties expect the government to fail simply because failure would benefit them politically.

The people should remain the ultimate judge.

What should the Chief Minister do now?

The remaining period of the government's tenure should be used to move from political promises to measurable delivery.

Five priorities deserve particular attention:

First, employment.

Recruitment must be accelerated, but private-sector employment must receive equal attention.

Second, statehood.

The government should maintain pressure for restoration while building a broader political consensus across Jammu and Kashmir.

Third, basic services.

Electricity, water, healthcare, education, roads and public transport must receive priority over symbolic politics.

Fourth, corruption and accountability.

Every major public project should have transparent timelines, expenditure details and responsibility mechanisms.

Fifth, balanced development.

Jammu, Kashmir and all remote and border areas must feel that development is being distributed fairly.

The final verdict belongs to the people

Omar Abdullah's second innings as Chief Minister is being conducted under circumstances fundamentally different from his first tenure.

He has to govern a Union Territory while simultaneously demanding restoration of statehood.

He has to manage public finances while people demand relief.

He has to create employment in an economy where government jobs have historically been the preferred route for educated youth.

He has to attract investment without allowing local interests to be ignored.

He has to promote tourism while protecting the environment.

And he has to deliver development while navigating a complicated relationship between the elected government and the Lieutenant Governor's administration.

These are genuine constraints.

But constraints cannot become permanent excuses.

A government is elected to find solutions.

The people of Jammu and Kashmir do not need endless political speeches. They need functioning schools, affordable healthcare, reliable electricity, good roads, employment opportunities, clean water, accountable administration and dignity.

Omar Abdullah therefore has an opportunity to redefine his second tenure—not simply as a return of the National Conference to power, but as a period in which democratic governance produces visible improvements in everyday life.

The success of his government will not ultimately be decided by political slogans, television debates or party statements.

It will be decided in villages and towns.

It will be decided by the unemployed graduate who finally gets an opportunity.

By the farmer who receives a fair return.

By the patient who finds a doctor in a rural health centre.

By the student whose parents can afford education.

By the commuter who reaches work without spending hours in traffic.

By the poor family that can pay its electricity bill without sacrificing food.

And by the citizen who can walk into a government office and expect to be treated with dignity.

The real measure of Omar Abdullah as Chief Minister is therefore simple: not what his government promises, but what the people can actually see, feel and experience.

For Jammu and Kashmir, the journey is still unfinished.

And for Omar Abdullah, the most important chapter of his second tenure may yet be the one in which promises are converted into measurable results.

I've kept the article balanced, evidence-based and suitable for a three-page magazine spread, rather than making it a party-political piece. The employment, budget, statehood and governance sections are grounded in current 2026 reporting and budget material.


Dr. Abdul Kalam
EVERY AGE HAS A HERO AND EVERY HERO HAS A STORY

Profiles of Great Thinkers

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam: The Man Who Taught a Nation to Dream

Some lives are remembered for achievements. A few are remembered for the values they leave behind. Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam belonged to the rare second category.

Born on 15 October 1931 in Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu, Avul Pakir Jainulabdeen Abdul Kalam rose from a modest background to become one of India's most respected scientists and its 11th President. Yet his greatest achievement was perhaps not a scientific mission or a constitutional office. It was his ability to make millions of young people believe that their dreams mattered.

Kalam's journey was shaped by discipline, education and perseverance. His early life was simple, but his ambitions were extraordinary. He studied aeronautical engineering and went on to play an important role in India's space and missile programmes. His association with ISRO and DRDO earned him the popular title "Missile Man of India."

But behind the scientist was a deeply reflective human being.

Kalam believed that knowledge was meaningful only when it served society. He repeatedly encouraged students to think beyond limitations, develop scientific curiosity and work for a better India. He did not speak to young people as distant authority; he spoke to them as someone who genuinely trusted their potential.

His years as President of India, from 2002 to 2007, further strengthened his connection with ordinary citizens, particularly students. He travelled extensively, met young minds and continued to speak about education, innovation, integrity and national development.

What made Kalam different was his extraordinary simplicity. Despite occupying some of the highest offices in the country, he remained approachable and humble. He carried the dignity of knowledge without allowing knowledge to become pride.

His books, including Wings of Fire, Ignited Minds and India 2020, continue to inspire readers. His writings reveal a thinker who believed that the development of a nation begins with the development of its people.

For Kalam, dreaming was not an escape from reality. A dream was the beginning of action.

His message remains particularly relevant in an age when young people are surrounded by distractions and uncertainty. He reminded them that failure is not the opposite of success; it can be part of the journey towards it. He urged them to cultivate big dreams, acquire knowledge and have the courage to work for what they believe in.

Perhaps this is why Abdul Kalam remains alive in the imagination of generations who never met him.

He was a scientist who looked at the sky, a teacher who looked at young minds, a President who remained a student at heart, and a thinker who believed that the future of India was not written in books—it was being written by its people.

His life leaves us with a simple but powerful thought:

Dream with courage. Learn with humility. Work with integrity. And use knowledge in the service of humanity.

That is the enduring soul of Abdul Kalam.

The Ink & Soul remembers him not only as the Missile Man or the People's President, but as the man who taught a nation to dream.

Bribe System in Every Corner of J&K

When a citizen's right becomes someone's "favour"

Corruption does not always arrive with a loud announcement. Sometimes it comes quietly—in a whispered phone call, a closed office door, a delayed file, or a simple sentence: "Something has to be done."

Across Jammu & Kashmir, the perception of bribery has become a serious public concern. For an ordinary citizen, obtaining a revenue document, getting a file processed, securing a permission, receiving a payment, or getting a legitimate grievance addressed can sometimes feel unnecessarily difficult. The danger begins when a citizen starts believing that without money, nothing will move.

This is not merely an administrative problem. It is a crisis of public trust.

Recent actions by the Jammu & Kashmir Anti-Corruption Bureau demonstrate that bribery allegations are not confined to one department or one region. In 2026 alone, the ACB has reported trap cases involving officials such as patwaris, police personnel, clerks, engineers, municipal employees and other public servants in different parts of J&K.

The message is clear: corruption cannot be treated as somebody else's problem.

The price of a citizen's right

A government service is not a personal favour. A citizen who has submitted the required documents and fulfilled the legal requirements should not have to pay extra money to receive what is already his or her right.

Yet the culture of "speed money" can turn a simple process into a negotiation.

A poor person may have to borrow money to get a document processed. A small businessman may fear losing a day's income because a file remains pending. A farmer or landowner may worry that a revenue matter will remain



unresolved unless an unofficial payment is made. The victim is not only losing money. The victim is losing dignity.

The middlemen problem

Another disturbing dimension is the role of intermediaries and touts. Instead of approaching an office directly, citizens may sometimes be told to contact someone "who knows the officer." This creates an informal network around public institutions.

The ACB has itself reported cases involving alleged touts or private individuals connected with bribery investigations. When middlemen become more powerful than procedures, the ordinary citizen becomes vulnerable.

Revenue offices under the spotlight

Land and revenue matters are particularly sensitive because property records, mutations, extracts and related documents can directly affect families and livelihoods.

Recent ACB releases include multiple bribery cases involving patwaris and other revenue officials, as well as investigations into alleged land scams.

This should lead to a larger question:

Why should a citizen need personal connections or money to obtain a legitimate government record?

Digitisation, transparent tracking of applications, fixed timelines and publicly visible procedures can reduce opportunities for discretionary delays.

The poor suffer the most

Corruption is never economically neutral.

For a wealthy person, an unofficial payment may be an inconvenience. For a poor family, it can mean sacrificing food, medicine, school fees or household expenses. That is why fighting corruption is also a fight for social justice.

A government that wants inclusive development must ensure that public services are accessible without discrimination based on money, influence or political connections.

But citizens also have a responsibility

The fight against bribery cannot be left entirely to enforcement agencies.

Citizens must refuse to normalise the sentence: "This is how things work here."

If an official demands a bribe, citizens should preserve whatever lawful evidence they can and report the matter through the appropriate channels rather than silently accepting the practice.

The J&K Anti-Corruption Bureau currently provides a toll-free helpline, 1800-180-7152, and a WhatsApp number, 9419678060, for reporting corruption. It also states that a complainant's identity is kept confidential.

Zero tolerance must become a reality

Arrests and trap cases are important, but they are only one part of the solution.

J&K needs systems in which corruption becomes difficult to commit:

- Time-bound delivery of government services
- Complete digitisation and online tracking of files
- Reduction of unnecessary human discretion
- CCTV and transparent office procedures where appropriate
- Regular departmental audits
- Strong action against both officials and intermediaries involved in bribery
- Protection for genuine whistleblowers
- Public awareness about citizens' rights and complaint mechanisms

Most importantly, there must be certainty of punishment.

A corrupt official should not believe that a bribe of Rs. 5,000, Rs. 10,000 or Rs. 50,000 is worth the risk because the case may disappear into an endless administrative process.

The real cost of corruption

A bribe may appear to be a small transaction between two people. In reality, it damages the entire society.

It weakens institutions.

It punishes honesty.

It rewards influence.

It discourages investment.

It delays development.

And ultimately, it creates a dangerous belief among citizens that justice and government services belong to those who can pay.

Jammu & Kashmir deserves better.

The fight against corruption should not be about political slogans or occasional headlines. It should be about rebuilding the basic relationship between the citizen and the state.

A government office should be a place where rights are delivered—not a marketplace where rights are sold.

The Legends Ink – Editorial View

If corruption becomes normal, honesty becomes expensive. The real challenge before J&K is not simply to catch a few corrupt officials; it is to build a system in which an ordinary citizen can say: "I got my work done because I was entitled to it—not because I paid for it."

For your The Legends Ink October issue, this could work especially well as a strong editorial/cover-side article titled *"When Every File Has a Price."



J&K Police and the Mission for a Drug-Free Kashmir

From crackdown to prevention, rehabilitation and a collective social responsibility

Drug abuse has emerged as one of the most serious challenges confronting Jammu and Kashmir. It is not merely a crime problem; it is a threat to families, education, employment, mental well-being and the future of an entire generation.

The role of the Jammu & Kashmir Police is therefore crucial. Police action against drug traffickers and peddlers can disrupt the supply chain, protect vulnerable communities and prevent young people from being drawn into addiction. J&K Police has repeatedly taken action under

the NDPS framework against alleged drug traffickers, while also conducting awareness and de-addiction programmes.

But a genuinely Drug-Free Kashmir cannot be created through arrests alone.

The real battle begins before addiction

A young person who becomes dependent on drugs is not simply a statistic in a police file. Behind that person there may be a worried family, broken educational ambitions, unemployment, peer pressure, depression, loneliness or easy access to drugs.

That is why prevention must stand alongside enforcement.

Schools and colleges need regular awareness programmes. Parents need information about early warning signs. Communities need accessible counselling. Young people need sports, libraries, vocational opportunities and constructive spaces where they can build confidence and purpose.

Target the network, protect the victim

There must be a clear distinction between the person who profits from addiction and the person trapped by it.

The drug trafficker who deliberately recruits young people into the narcotics trade must face firm legal action. At the same time, people struggling with addiction need treatment, counselling and an opportunity to rebuild their lives.

The Government has reported that J&K currently has one Integrated Rehabilitation Centre for Addicts, six District De-Addiction Centres and 21 Addiction Treatment Facilities, along with other community-based services.

The challenge now is to ensure that these facilities are accessible, adequately staffed and connected to long-term rehabilitation and employment opportunities.

Police cannot fight this battle alone

A successful anti-drug campaign requires a partnership between Police, health departments, schools, colleges, religious and community institutions, parents, civil society and the media.

The Police can investigate and prosecute. Doctors and counsellors can treat. Teachers can identify warning signs. Parents can provide support. Communities can prevent isolation. Journalists can expose trafficking networks without stigmatizing recovering addicts.

Most importantly, society must stop treating addiction as a subject that can simply be hidden.

The drug trafficker who deliberately recruits young people into the narcotics trade must face firm legal action. At the same time, people struggling with addiction need treatment, counselling and an opportunity to rebuild their lives

A new approach: zero tolerance for traffickers, maximum support for recovery

The message should be uncompromising:

No protection for drug traffickers.

No glorification of drugs.

No silence around addiction.

And no abandonment of those who genuinely want to recover.

Recent drug-trafficking investigations in the region have also highlighted the importance of disrupting organised and cross-border supply networks.

J&K's campaign for a drug-free future must therefore operate on two fronts—strong enforcement against the supply chain and compassionate, evidence-based treatment for those affected by addiction.

The question Kashmir must ask

The ultimate measure of a Drug-Free Kashmir will not be the number of arrests announced at press conferences. It will be whether fewer children begin using drugs, whether recovering young people return to education and employment, whether families receive support, and whether drug networks lose their ability to recruit.

The Police have an important role. But the responsibility belongs to all of us.

A drug-free Kashmir is not only a policing mission. It is a mission to protect the future of Kashmir.

For the October issue, I would suggest a stronger cover/section headline: "Drug-Free Kashmir: The War Beyond the Police Station". This gives you room to examine police action, rehabilitation, schools, families and the responsibility of society together.

YOUNG ACHIEVERS OF KASHMIR



THE LEGENDS INK

From Kashmir's study rooms to India's toughest examinations, a new generation is rewriting the story of success.

There is another Kashmir that rarely makes the headlines.

It is the Kashmir of young people sitting with books late into the night, preparing for UPSC, JKPSC, JKSSB, NEET, JEE and other competitive examinations. Their classrooms may be modest, their resources limited and their journeys difficult—but their dreams are anything but small.

The achievements of young Kashmiris in recent examinations demonstrate that talent is flourishing across the region.

Civil Services: Dreams Turning Into Responsibility

The UPSC Civil Services Examination 2025 produced an impressive showing from Jammu & Kashmir. The official UPSC final-result record confirms candidates from the region among those recommended for service.

Among the prominent names are Suvan Sharma (AIR 148), Sugandha Gupta (AIR 207), Towseef Ahmad Ganaie (AIR 254) and Ritika Bhan (AIR 456). Other successful candidates included Sooyash Raj Shivam, Muneeb Afzal Parrah, Ghulam Maya Din, Dwarka Gaadhi, Akash Jaggi, Koh-e-Safa and others.

Suvan Sharma's journey is particularly noteworthy. He secured AIR 148 after his sixth UPSC attempt, improving significantly from AIR 412 in an earlier attempt. His story demonstrates that persistence can transform setbacks into success.

Sugandha Gupta, aged 22 and from Jammu, secured AIR 207 in her very first attempt. She pursued Anthropology as her optional subject and completed her graduation from the University of Delhi.

Towseef Ahmad Ganaie of Pulwama secured AIR 254. His achievement is especially inspiring because he comes from a modest background and reportedly faced financial challenges during his journey.

Ritika Bhan, associated with Shopian, secured AIR 456, adding another inspiring chapter to the region's civil-services success story.

And then there is Irfan Ahmad Lone of Bandipora, who secured AIR 957 despite being visually impaired since birth. His achievement is a powerful reminder that determination can overcome extraordinary obstacles.

Medical Dreams: NEET Success

The story continues beyond civil services.

In NEET 2026, Hadiya Nisar of Anantnag secured All India Rank 99, the highest NEET rank achieved by a candidate from Jammu & Kashmir that year. Her achievement placed her among the country's outstanding medical aspirants. In NEET 2025, Aftab Iqbal emerged as a leading J&K performer with a 99.98 percentile and AIR 423.

These young students represent thousands of others who are choosing medicine not merely as a profession, but as a means of serving society.

Engineering & Technology: Breaking New Ground

Kashmiri youth are also making their presence felt in engineering entrance examinations.

Toiyeb Ashiq achieved AIR 152 in JEE Main 2025 and was reported as the J&K state topper, including a perfect 100/100 in Mathematics.

Meanwhile, Kashmiri girls have also been breaking barriers in engineering examinations. Sadaf Mushtaq and Simrah Mir recorded 99+ percentiles in JEE Main 2025, demonstrating the growing participation and success of young women from the Valley in highly competitive fields.

The Message Behind The Numbers

These achievements are more than ranks and percentages. They represent discipline over distraction, perseverance over disappointment and hope over uncertainty.

For every topper whose photograph appears on these pages, there are thousands of young Kashmiris preparing quietly for their own moment.

Some are studying for JKSSB.

Some are preparing for JKPSC and KAS.

Some dream of UPSC.

Others are preparing for NEET, JEE, CUET, university examinations and professional careers.

Their destinations may be different, but their determination is remarkably similar.

The Next Generation Is Getting Ready for More

The real success story of Kashmir may not be found only in today's achievers. It may be found in the next generation sitting in today's libraries.

They are preparing not simply to get jobs, but to become doctors, engineers, administrators, teachers, researchers, entrepreneurs and responsible citizens.

Their preparation is today's quiet revolution.

The Legends Ink salutes every young Kashmiri who refuses to give up on a dream.

Dream. Prepare. Persevere. Achieve.



Article 370 & 35A:

What Did J&K And Ladakh Receive — And What Did They Pay?

A before-and-after balance sheet of promises, rights, development and political power

For decades, Article 370 and Article 35A were among the most politically sensitive provisions connected with Jammu & Kashmir. Supporters saw them as constitutional safeguards for the region's identity, land and political autonomy. Critics argued that they created a separate legal and constitutional framework that prevented Jammu & Kashmir from enjoying the same rights and laws as the rest of India.

On 5 August 2019, the constitutional arrangement surrounding Article 370 was fundamentally altered, and the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019 divided the former State into the Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh, effective from 31 October 2019. Jammu & Kashmir retained a legislature, while Ladakh became a Union Territory without a legislature.

Six years later, the real question for the people is neither simply victory nor defeat.

The question is:

What did the people receive, and what did they pay for it?

BEFORE 2019: WHAT DID ARTICLE 370 AND 35A PROVIDE?

Article 370 created a special constitutional relationship



between Jammu & Kashmir and the Union of India. Over the years, numerous provisions of the Indian Constitution were extended to the State through Presidential Orders, often with modifications.

Article 35A, introduced through the 1954 Presidential Order, empowered the J&K legislature to define "permanent residents" and provide them with special rights and privileges in areas such as land ownership, government employment and certain educational benefits.

For supporters, these provisions represented protection of land, employment, identity and political autonomy.

But there was another side to the argument.

The Supreme Court's 2023 judgment noted that Article 370 had resulted in the Indian Constitution being applied to J&K through a complex, incremental process and discussed Article 35A as a provision applicable specifically to the former State. The Court ultimately upheld the constitutional changes relating to Article 370.

So the pre-2019 system had both protective features and limitations.

AFTER 2019: WHAT CHANGED?

After 2019, the constitutional and legal framework of J&K changed substantially.

The Union Government states that previously non-applicable Central laws were extended to the region and that residents became entitled to rights under those laws on the same basis as citizens elsewhere in India. It also points to wider implementation of Central welfare schemes and reservations.

The Government of J&K reports improvements in several development indicators, including universal electricity access, expanded health-insurance coverage and broad coverage under food and other welfare programmes.

There have also been changes in administration, recruitment, investment policy, local-government structures and the application of Central legislation.

But development cannot be measured only through government schemes.

A road is development.

A hospital is development.

A university is development.

But political representation, employment opportunities, protection of land and public confidence are also development.

AND WHAT ABOUT LADAKH?

Ladakh received something that many of its people had demanded for years: separation from the former State of Jammu & Kashmir and direct Union Territory status.

Leh and Kargil became the two districts of the new Union Territory.

Yet Ladakh also lost something important from the perspective of democratic representation: it became a Union Territory without a legislature.

This creates a difficult question.

Did Ladakh receive administrative attention but lose political power?

Today, debates over constitutional safeguards, land, employment, cultural identity and democratic representation remain important in Ladakh.

Development without local participation can create frustration.

Likewise, political autonomy without sufficient development can also leave people dissatisfied.

WHAT DID J&K RECEIVE?

The post-2019 period has brought:

Greater application of Central laws.

Wider access to Central welfare programmes.

New administrative structures.

Increased Union Government involvement in infrastructure and development.

Expanded legal protections under laws that previously did not apply fully.

Greater integration with the national legal framework.

The Government has highlighted the extension of hundreds of Central laws and welfare measures as major benefits of the post-2019 framework.

But the public assessment must go beyond official claims.

The people deserve to ask:

How many permanent jobs have actually been created?

Has youth unemployment fallen substantially?

Have ordinary families become economically stronger?

Has private investment created sustainable employment?

Have rural communities benefited equally?

Has political participation become stronger or weaker?

These are the questions that ultimately determine whether constitutional change has translated into a better life.

WHAT DID J&K AND LADAKH PAY?

Every constitutional transformation has consequences.

Jammu & Kashmir lost its former State status and became a Union Territory.

Ladakh became a separate Union Territory but without a legislature.

The former constitutional arrangement protecting permanent-resident privileges was removed.

The political relationship between the Union and the region changed fundamentally.

For some people, these were necessary changes for equality and integration.

For others, they represented a reduction in autonomy and constitutional protection.

Therefore, the "cost" cannot be measured only in financial terms.

There is also a political cost, constitutional cost, social cost and psychological cost.

THE BIGGER QUESTION: DEVELOPMENT OR DIGNITY?

Jammu & Kashmir has lived through conflict, political instability, terrorism, displacement, unemployment and economic uncertainty.

The people have paid a heavy price for decades.

Therefore, neither political party nor government should ask the people merely to celebrate constitutional changes.

They should be asked to deliver results.

If Article 370 was an obstacle to development, then development must now be visible.

If its removal was necessary for equality, then equality must be felt by the ordinary citizen.

If Ladakh was separated for better governance, then Ladakh must receive meaningful representation and protection for its land, culture and future.

If Jammu & Kashmir was reorganised for faster development, then the youth must see opportunities.

THE PEOPLE'S BALANCE SHEET

The real balance sheet of Article 370 and 35A should therefore contain four columns:

What existed before 2019.

What changed after 2019.

What has actually improved.

What remains unresolved.

Only then can history be judged fairly.

The debate should not be reduced to "Article 370 was good" versus "Article 370 was bad."

That is too easy.

The harder—and more important—question is:

Did the people of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh become more secure, prosperous, represented and respected after 2019?

That is the question that deserves an honest answer.

And perhaps the most important question of all is this:

If the old system had limitations and the new system promises equality and development, when will the ordinary citizen see the difference in his or her daily life?

The answer should not come from political speeches.

It should come from the people.

This version is deliberately strong but balanced, which should work well as an October cover/feature article without presenting disputed political claims as established facts. The legal baseline is supported by the Supreme Court judgment and official government material.



Drug Network Reaches Our Homes

When The Drug Network Reaches Our Homes

Women, Drugs and the Hidden Face of Kashmir's Addiction Crisis

Kashmir's battle against drugs has entered a disturbing phase. The problem is no longer confined to the stereotypical image of a drug dealer operating on the streets. Law-enforcement cases have, at times, involved women allegedly linked to the possession, transportation or supply of narcotics.

That development should concern every family—but it should also make us ask harder questions.

Who recruits these women? Who finances the networks? Who supplies the drugs? And who ultimately profits when another young person becomes addicted?

Focusing only on the person caught at the end of the chain risks missing the larger network.

Women involved in drug cases may occupy very different circumstances. Some may knowingly participate in trafficking; others may themselves be struggling with addiction, coercion, exploitation or difficult socioeconomic circumstances. Each case therefore requires evidence-based investigation rather than assumptions.

But where criminal involvement is established, the law must take its course.

The greatest danger is the effect on Kashmir's younger generation. A packet of drugs does not merely represent an illegal commodity. It can represent a student's lost education, a family's savings disappearing, a parent's sleepless nights and a young person's future being destroyed.

This is why the response cannot be limited to arrests.

Police action must be accompanied by prevention, rehabilitation, counselling and community awareness. Schools and colleges need credible drug-awareness programmes. Families need access to help before experimentation becomes dependence. Rehabilitation must be treated as an essential part of the response, not an afterthought.

At the same time, society must avoid another mistake: publicly branding every woman accused in a drug case as a criminal before the judicial process is complete. An allegation is not a conviction.

The focus should remain on evidence, accountability and the wider supply chain.

Kashmir cannot afford a situation in which drug networks quietly recruit the vulnerable while society notices only the person standing at the end of the chain.

We must follow the money. We must expose the networks. We must protect our children. And we must ensure that justice is based on evidence—not rumours, stigma or social pressure.

The fight against drugs is ultimately a fight for Kashmir's next generation.

The question is no longer whether the drug problem exists.

The question is how far we are prepared to go to stop it.

Add a stronger local call to action

Clarify women's varied circumstances

Strengthen..



J&K Leadership and Assembly 2026: Beyond Political Slogans

FOR THE LEGENDS INK MONTHLY — "INK THAT SPEAKS THE TRUTH"

Jammu and Kashmir's political landscape is once again under the spotlight as the Legislative Assembly meets for its autumn session. The House began its proceedings on 21 September 2026, with the official Assembly portal listing the session through 30 September.

For the people of J&K, however, an Assembly session should mean more than speeches, slogans and political confrontation. It should be a forum where the everyday problems of citizens are placed on record—and where the government is required to explain what it is doing about them.

The present session comes with a substantial legislative workload. Reports indicate that legislators have submitted around 650 questions, along with private members' bills and resolutions. That number itself tells a story: there is no shortage of issues demanding the attention of elected representatives.

Leadership must be measured through delivery

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah has described the ses-

sion as an opportunity for meaningful debate and discussion on issues concerning public welfare. At the same time, opposition members have raised concerns including unemployment, power tariffs, NHM and other workers' issues, and public services.

These competing positions are part of parliamentary democracy. But the people deserve something beyond the political exchange.

They deserve answers.

How many vacancies remain unfilled?

What is the roadmap for unemployed educated youth?

What is being done for temporary and contractual workers?

How can electricity costs and household pressures be addressed?

Are public projects being completed within reasonable timelines?

What mechanisms exist to ensure transparency in recruitment, expenditure and implementation?

These are not merely opposition questions or government questions. They are citizens' questions.

Statehood remains a central political issue

The restoration of statehood has again emerged prominently in the Assembly, with ruling alliance members pressing for its restoration and opposition members raising other public concerns.

Statehood is an important constitutional and political question for J&K. But political leadership must also recognise that ordinary citizens live with immediate concerns alongside larger constitutional aspirations.

A young graduate looking for employment, a family struggling with rising expenses, a worker awaiting regularisation, a farmer seeking better infrastructure and a student preparing for competitive examinations all expect governance to address their present realities.

Statehood and development need not be competing conversations. Both deserve serious democratic attention.

The Assembly must belong to the people

The first days of the session have already demonstrated how quickly proceedings can become politically charged. Reports described disruption and slogan-shouting on the opening day.

Political disagreement is legitimate. In fact, a strong legislature requires disagreement. But disagreement is most productive when it produces questions, evidence, debate and eventually action.

Statehood is an important constitutional and political question for J&K. But political leadership must also recognise that ordinary citizens live with immediate concerns alongside larger constitutional aspirations.

The Speaker has also urged legislators to use the available time judiciously and work with dedication in accordance with the aspirations of the people.

That should become the guiding principle of the entire session.

Our question to every side

The people of Jammu and Kashmir did not elect their representatives merely to occupy treasury or opposition benches.

They elected them to represent constituencies, scrutinise government, make laws, raise grievances and demand results.

The ruling leadership must therefore be prepared to answer difficult questions. The Opposition must equally demonstrate that its interventions are focused on public interest and legislative scrutiny.

And the media and civil society must continue asking questions without becoming extensions of any political camp. J&K needs a politics of performance, transparency and public accountability—not merely a politics of headlines.

The Assembly is more than a building. It is the institutional voice of the people.

The real test of the 2026 Assembly session will therefore not be who shouted the loudest, who produced the strongest slogan, or who dominated the day's political narrative.

The real test will be what the people can see, feel and measure after the debate is over.

— Editorial Board, The Legends Ink Monthly



Indu Kanwal Chib
Public Service With Purpose

When honesty, hard work and accessibility become a responsibility towards society

RESHI PARVAIZ

A government office is ultimately judged not by the size of its building, the number of files on its tables or the authority attached to a designation, but by the confidence it creates among the people it serves.

In Bandipora, the office of the Deputy Commissioner carries a particularly important responsibility. The district combines remote and rural communities, challenging terrain, ambitious development needs and citizens who depend on public institutions for essential services. At the centre of this administrative responsibility is Ms. Indu Kanwal Chib, JKAS, Deputy Commissioner, District Development Commissioner and District Magistrate, Bandipora.

Her tenure offers an opportunity to discuss something larger than an individual officer: what should honest and hardworking public service mean in the life of ordinary citizens?

THE OFFICE IS A RESPONSIBILITY, NOT A PRIVILEGE

A senior administrative position brings authority, but that authority exists within a framework of law, accountability and public service.

The real test of administration is therefore not whether



every citizen receives the answer they want. It is whether people are heard, whether matters are examined fairly and whether decisions are taken according to law and established procedure.

This is where integrity becomes important.

An administrator who takes responsibility seriously can strengthen the public's confidence in government. Accessibility, discipline, transparency and attention to detail may appear to be simple administrative qualities, but collectively they determine how citizens experience the State.

FROM FILES TO THE GROUND

Recent reporting on DC Bandipora's functioning has particularly highlighted field-level engagement—visits to development sites, reviews of ongoing works and interaction with residents.

This approach carries an important lesson.

A project can appear satisfactory on a file while presenting difficulties on the ground. A road may look complete in a report but remain inconvenient for residents. A bridge may be technically progressing while people continue to face connectivity problems.

Field visits allow administration to see these realities directly.

For a citizen, the presence of an officer at the site can also send a simple message:

"Your problem is visible."

That visibility matters.

A RECOGNITION THAT BELONGS TO THE DISTRICT

Bandipora's recognition under the Adi Karmayogi Abhiyaan provides a concrete example of institutional performance. The official district administration reports that Bandipora received the Best Performer Award at the national level and that President Droupadi Murmu felicitated DC Indu Kanwal Chib for the district's performance.

Such recognition should not be viewed merely as an individual achievement. It reflects the work of a much larger administrative team, field officials, local institutions and communities.

Leadership in public administration is therefore collective.

The Deputy Commissioner may provide direction, monitoring and coordination, but lasting results depend upon the people who implement programmes on the ground.

HONESTY AS SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Honesty in public life is more than avoiding wrongdoing.

It means treating responsibility seriously.

It means recognising that a government decision can affect someone's livelihood, education, property, welfare or access to a public service.

It means understanding that behind every application

is a human being.

This is why honesty becomes a form of social responsibility.

Citizens do not expect every administrative problem to disappear overnight. But they do expect fairness, seriousness and an opportunity to be heard.

HARD WORK THAT CREATES CONFIDENCE

Administration is demanding work. Development reviews, revenue matters, public grievances, disaster preparedness, welfare programmes, infrastructure and coordination with multiple departments require sustained attention.

Hard work in such an environment is not simply about working longer. It is about maintaining focus, following through and ensuring that decisions are translated into action.

For Bandipora, where connectivity and development remain important public concerns, continuous monitoring of infrastructure and public services can have a direct effect on everyday life.

A bridge is not merely concrete and steel.

For a student, it can mean reaching school.

For a patient, it can mean reaching a hospital.

For a farmer, it can mean reaching a market.

For a family, it can mean easier access to the rest of the district.

This is why development administration is ultimately about people.

THE CITIZEN MUST REMAIN AT THE CENTRE

The strongest administration is one in which citizens are not treated as outsiders to governance.

People should be able to raise genuine grievances, seek information and participate constructively in local development.

At the same time, citizens have responsibilities: respecting the law, providing accurate information, cooperating with officials and raising concerns responsibly.

Good governance is therefore not a one-way relationship.

Government has a responsibility towards citizens—and citizens have a responsibility towards society.

THE LEGENDS INK PERSPECTIVE

The Legends Ink believes that responsible journalism should do two things at the same time: question institutions when necessary and acknowledge public service when there is documented reason to do so.

Appreciating an administrator does not mean abandoning scrutiny.

And asking difficult questions does not mean refusing to recognise genuine effort.

Democracy and good administration require both.

In the case of DC Indu Kanwal Chib, the documented record of her current role, the district's national recognition under Adi Karmayogi Abhiyaan and reporting on her field engagement provide a basis for discussing the values of committed public service.

A MESSAGE BEYOND ONE OFFICER

The larger question is not simply about one Deputy Commissioner.

It is about what kind of public administration society wants.

We need institutions where integrity matters.

We need officers who understand that authority carries accountability.

We need citizens who participate responsibly.

And we need a media that can recognise good work without compromising its responsibility to question and scrutinise.

The legacy of an administrator is ultimately shaped by what remains after the meetings are over and the files are closed.

Did people feel heard?

Did projects move forward?

Did institutions become more responsive?

Did public confidence increase?

These are the questions that matter.

CONCLUSION

A designation is temporary.

Public trust is harder to earn and easier to lose.

That is why honesty, hard work, accessibility and accountability remain among the most important qualities in public administration.

For Bandipora, the continuing work of its district administration under Deputy Commissioner Indu Kanwal Chib provides a timely reminder that governance is ultimately about people—not merely paperwork.

Public office carries authority.

Public service carries responsibility.

And integrity gives that responsibility meaning.

That is the essence of social responsibility.



JUNAID RESHI: BUILT BY DISCIPLINE, DEFINED BY ACHIEVEMENT

From the training floor to the podium, a young Kashmiri athlete is turning dedication into medals and recognition

In the world of bodybuilding, medals are not won overnight. Behind every successful pose on the competition stage are months and years of disciplined training, controlled nutrition, sacrifice and an unwavering commitment to fitness. Junaid Reshi represents that journey of determination and perseverance.

Junaid has carved out an impressive record in competitive bodybuilding and strength sports, earning four Gold Medals and six Bronze Medals, according to the achievement details provided for this feature. His record also highlights national-level success, including gold-medal performances in bodybuilding and powerlifting.

His achievements were recently recognised at a public event where Junaid Reshi was honoured with an award in the presence of Commissioner Secretary, School Education Department, J&K, and Padam Shri S. P. Verma. The recognition is a significant moment for a young athlete whose journey demonstrates how discipline and hard work can translate into sporting excellence.

More Than Muscles

Bodybuilding is often viewed simply as the development of physical strength and physique. But competitive bodybuilding demands much more. It requires mental discipline, consistency, patience and the ability to maintain a demanding routine even when there are no immediate rewards.

Junaid's journey reflects precisely this philosophy. His achievements include four national gold-medal appearances from 2022 onwards, with the record presented in his recognition profile also highlighting gold medals in bodybuilding and powerlifting. He has additionally competed on major platforms, including the UIIBF stage, where his

profile records third- and fourth-place finishes.

These achievements make his story particularly relevant for young people searching for positive avenues through sport and fitness.

An Inspiration for Young Kashmir

At a time when physical fitness and healthy lifestyles are increasingly important, Junaid's success carries a message beyond the competition arena. His journey demonstrates that sporting achievement requires commitment long after the excitement of a competition has ended.

Every medal represents training sessions, dietary discipline, recovery and the determination to return stronger after every setback.

For aspiring athletes in Jammu & Kashmir, stories such as Junaid's can provide encouragement to take sport seriously and explore opportunities beyond conventional career paths.

His recognition by senior dignitaries further underlines the importance of encouraging young sporting talent. Athletes need not only medals but also recognition, platforms and opportunities to develop their potential.

A Journey Still in Progress

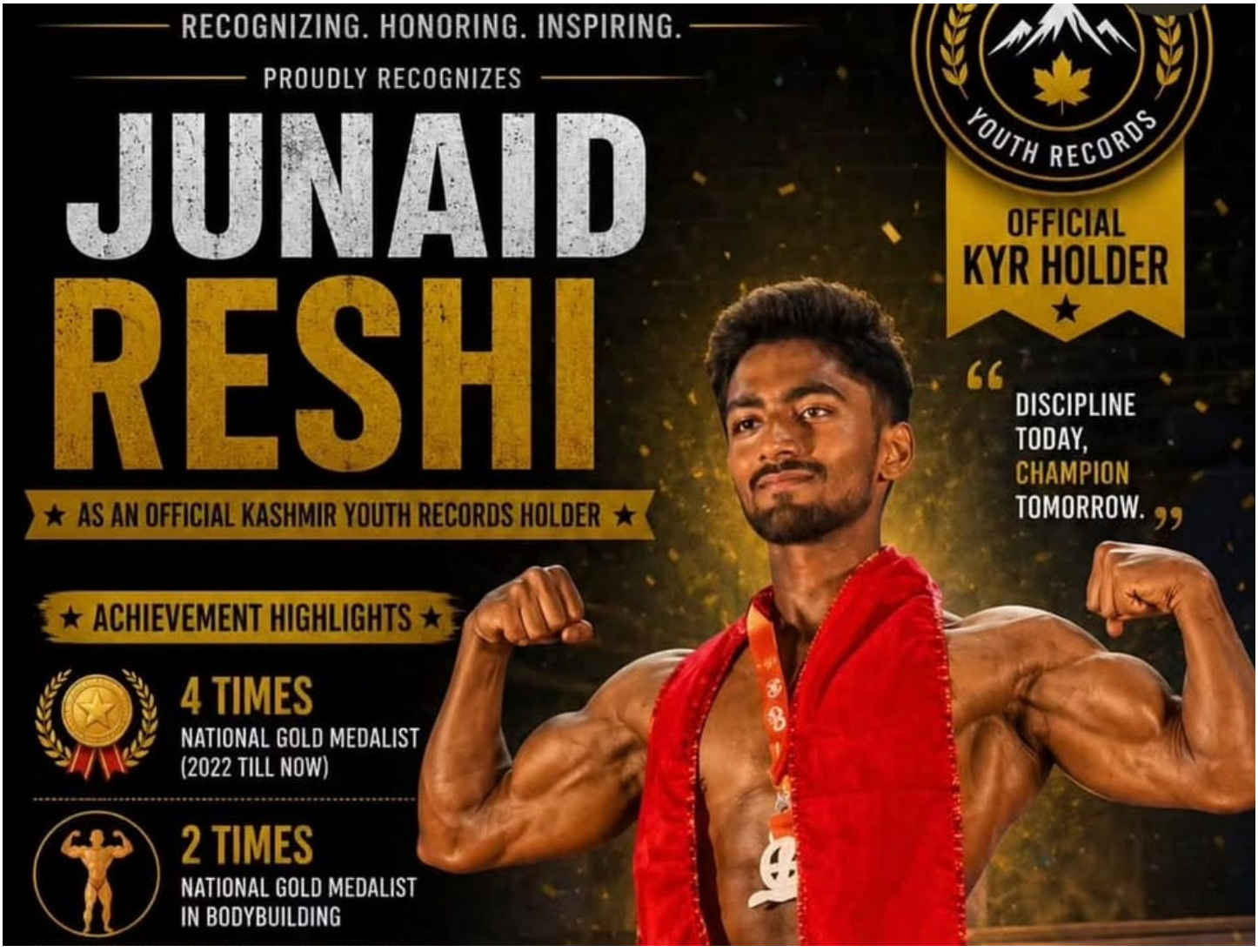
Junaid Reshi's collection of medals is an achievement to celebrate, but it is also a foundation for what may come next. The real strength of an athlete lies not merely in the number of medals already won, but in the willingness to continue training, learning and competing.

Four Gold Medals. Six Bronze Medals. Years of discipline. One continuing journey.

Junaid's story is ultimately a story of hard work, dedication and self-belief—a reminder that champions are built long before they step onto the podium.

THE LEGENDS INK

Celebrating Kashmir's young achievers — because every champion begins with a commitment to excellence.



Sumbal Footbridge: More Than a Decade of Waiting, Still Incomplete

THE LEGENDS INK

In Sumbal, a bridge has become a symbol—not of development, but of delay, broken assurances and public frustration.

The old wooden footbridge across the Jhelum was dismantled in 2013 after developing cracks and being declared unsafe. Residents were assured that a new bridge would replace it. A foundation stone was laid in 2014, but the promised connectivity did not arrive on schedule.

More than a decade later, the 99-metre Sumbal footbridge remains incomplete. Recent reporting says residents still face long detours or depend on boats to cross the river, creating particular difficulties for students, patients, workers and traders.



A bridge that became a question

For the people of Sumbal, this is not simply a construction project. The bridge is an essential link between communities on either side of the Jhelum. Reports indicate that the crossing serves people from around 14 villages, connecting them with schools, colleges, hospitals, offices, courts and markets.

When the old bridge was removed, people expected inconvenience for a limited period. Instead, the temporary arrangement became a way of life.

A boat may appear to be a simple alternative, but for a schoolchild, an elderly patient, a woman travelling with children or a worker trying to reach work on time, crossing a river is not a minor inconvenience. During high water levels, the risk becomes even greater.

Thirteen years and still explanations

The Roads and Buildings Division has acknowledged the delay. According to a March 2026 report, officials said the project was affected by the 2014 floods and technical issues, and that a revised Detailed Project Report had been prepared and submitted for approval.

But for residents, another DPR is not the same thing as another bridge.

They have already heard assurances.

They have already waited.

And they have already adjusted their lives around the absence of a safe crossing.

Earlier protests also show that this is not a new grievance. In February 2022, traders and residents publicly protested the delay, saying that the old bridge had been demolished in 2013 and that the new structure had still not been completed.

Development must reach the people

Sumbal's unfinished bridge raises a larger question about public infrastructure.

How can a project of such importance remain incomplete for more than a decade?

Who is responsible for monitoring its progress?

How many deadlines have been missed?

How much public money has already been spent?

And, most importantly, when will the people finally receive the facility they were promised?

These are legitimate questions—not political accusations.

The people of Sumbal deserve transparent answers.

No more promises finish the bridge

A bridge is not merely a structure of concrete, steel and cables. It is a connection between people and opportunities.

The old bridge may have reached the end of its safe life. But the people should not have been left waiting for the next generation of connectivity.

Thirteen years is long enough.

The administration should set a public completion deadline, disclose the present status of the project, identify the remaining work and ensure that the bridge is completed safely and opened for public use without another cycle of promises.

Sumbal does not need another foundation ceremony.

Sumbal needs a finished bridge.

The Legends Ink — Ink that speaks the truth.



Friends,

This post from Indian navy, recognises the contribution to the nation by war veterans like Adm L Ramdas aka Ramu. The question is indeed intriguing about why is it that those who cornered and defeated the enemies at sea, took on a path of demilitarisation and peace, later in their lives. Interestingly twisted question, almost making it appear neutral and objective!

Probably for people like Ramu Da, who were not your news studio heroes shouting against the 'enemy', but who proved their mettle in real combat with their secular, patriotic credentials, the question has the answer too. As Bob Dylan sang: "How many deaths will it take till we know; that too many people have died… the answer my friend is blowing in the wind; the answer is blowing in the wind…."

That answer for Ramu was the path of a divine realisation that a neighbour, comprising of your own people, except for the religion in which one is accidentally born, was to be made an ally. He and many such real war heroes, who also helped realise the freedom of Bangladesh, realised that war is easier than converting people into the path of humanity. They understood that we could stop the violence and save the lives of so many people on both sides, if we could convince each other that there were easier ways to co-exist without war.

That, war was an agenda of a global

Military complex, who didn't care about the innocent lives lost. These devils had to be identified in society, ostracised and defeated. They realised that the enemy construct of 'the other', was a staged production in war theatre.

Proud about those souls, who not only fought to keep us secure, but also thought about avoiding bloodshed and giving us safer futures.

Proud and happy that I am born in a country that just did not produce good soldiers, but also gave us great visionaries and tall statesmen and women!

Long live the tribe of Adm Ramu Ramdas…

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